



DAN COUGHLIN

Baseball: Asterisks, not stars

Tidbits, impressions and reactions from a typical week on the beat.

Yes, the replacement players will be included in the next edition of "The Baseball Encyclopedia" published by McMillan. The current edition includes the career records of slightly more than 14,000 players. The next one will have almost 1,000 additional names if this season opens with replacement players.

Morris Eckhouse, executive director of the Society for American Baseball Research (SABR), headquartered in downtown Cleveland in the Caxton Building, said baseball's official record books already include previous replacement players.

"The term 'replacement players' is new to the lexicon of baseball, but the precedent is not," said Eckhouse.

He points out that in 1912 the Detroit Tigers went on strike for one day in support of their teammate, Ty Cobb, who was suspended for going into the stands and beating up a heckler.

"The Tigers were playing in Philadelphia and so they recruited sandlot players and other amateurs and they lost to the Philadelphia Athletics, 24-2. Not only are those names in 'The Baseball Encyclopedia' for one game, but the Detroit pitcher, Allen Travers, is in the record book for allowing the most runs in one game in the American League, all 24 runs. There is even a notation that it was Travers' only major league game," said Eckhouse.

Furthermore, said Eckhouse, historians view the World War II years as replacement baseball because so many stars were in military service from 1941-45. That explains why Pete Gray, a 30-year-old outfielder with one arm, played 77 games for the St. Louis Browns in 1945. He's in the book.

■ ■ ■

Are you sitting down? Here's some good news for Indians' fans.

Those massive foul poles at Jacobs Field are coming down. They'll be replaced by thinner poles later this month. The old poles are two feet thick, which obstructed the view of fans in the right field lower deck. The new ones will be only a few inches thick. Good idea. The Indians wasted no time remedying an unforeseen problem.

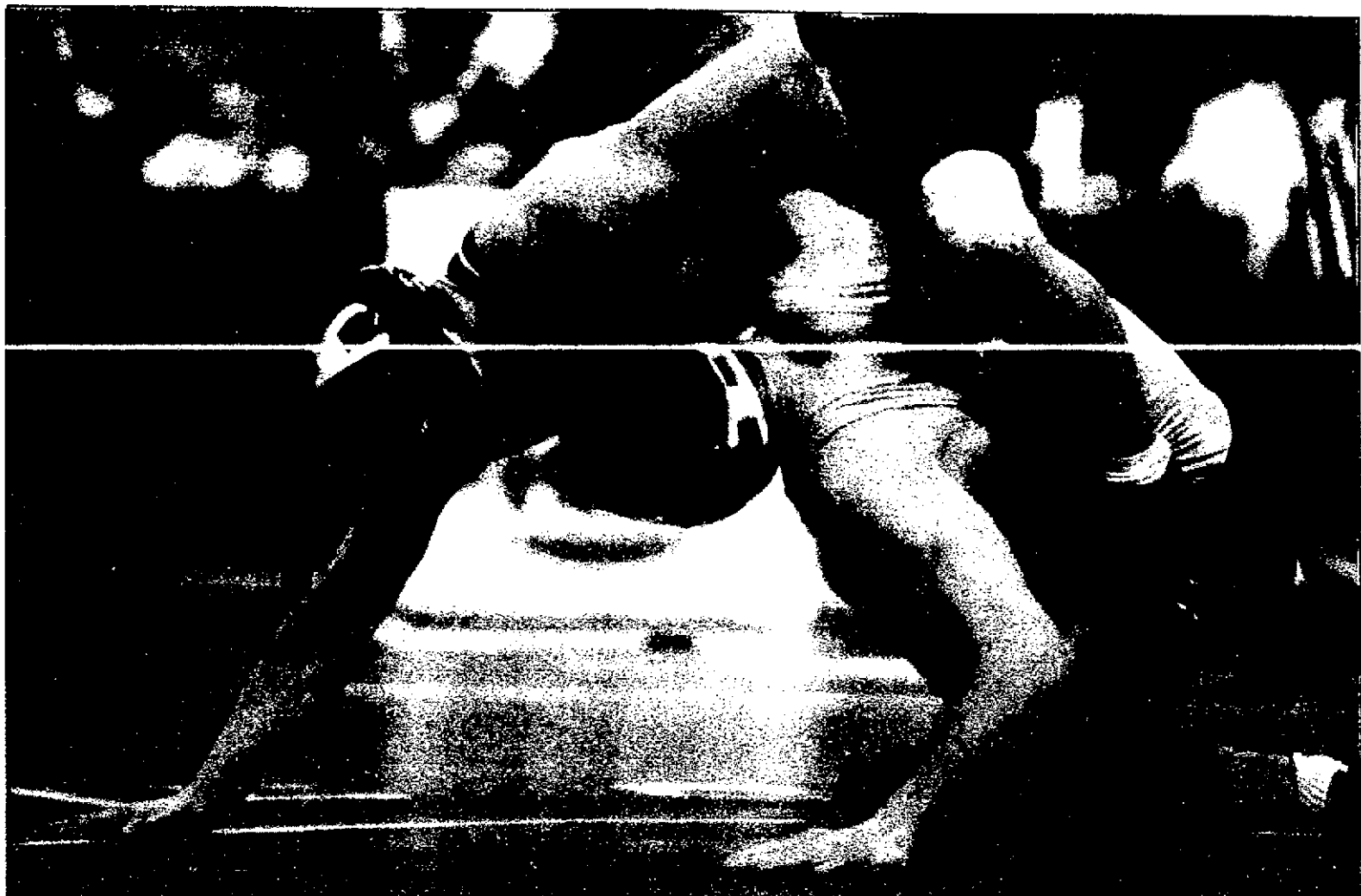
Meanwhile, next door at the Gund, they're talking about raising the basketball floor a few inches to give the fans in the 348 seats a better view of the games.

■ ■ ■

Just read W.P. Kinsella's latest "The Dixon Cornbelt League," a collection of nine short stories. Weird, weird, weird. He has short-stops turning into wolves, catchers becoming owls and Roberto Clemente washing ashore — alive — 20 years after he disappeared in the Caribbean. By comparison, his most famous work, "Shoeless Joe," on which the movie "Field of

See COUGHLIN, B7

COLUMNIST DOUG CLARKE takes a timeout from sports to comment on some other important matters. **D7**



AP / Special to the Chronicle-Telegram

WRAPPED UP IN HIS WORK: Avon Lake's Shawn Bristow, top, tries his best to put Lake Catholic's Brandon Steinmetz on his

back during Saturday's state wrestling finals. Bristow ended up second after losing 7-0.

State crown fits area wrestlers

Columbia's Harvey knocks off previously unbeaten opponent

Judie Asp
The Chronicle-Telegram

DIVISION III

FAIRBORN — Columbia's Neal Harvey owns the 189-pound Division III state championship.

Raider teammate heavy-weight John Higgs had to settle for runnerup honors, falling to

MAC-8 rival Tim Courtad of Aurora, 18-3. Courtad finished second at state last year.

Harvey (34-1) stunned previously unbeaten junior Rocky

See HARVEY, B3

St. Edward's King and Clement conclude prep careers in style

Judie Asp
The Chronicle-Telegram

DIVISION I

FAIRBORN — Before Saturday, close was as close as they had ever come to a state wrestling championship.

No longer.

Before a record crowd of 11,464, St. Edward seniors Brad

See CHAMPS, B3

Defense difference for Falls

Jim Jablonski
The Chronicle-Telegram

BEREA — There are a lot of cliches that hang around despite being proven wrong time and time again.

Take that one about how "you can't beat a good team three times."

The Olmsted Falls Bulldogs made a lie of that belief and in the process won their third district championship in the last six years by defeating the Bay Rockets, 56-43, in the Baldwin-Wallace Division II tournament Saturday.

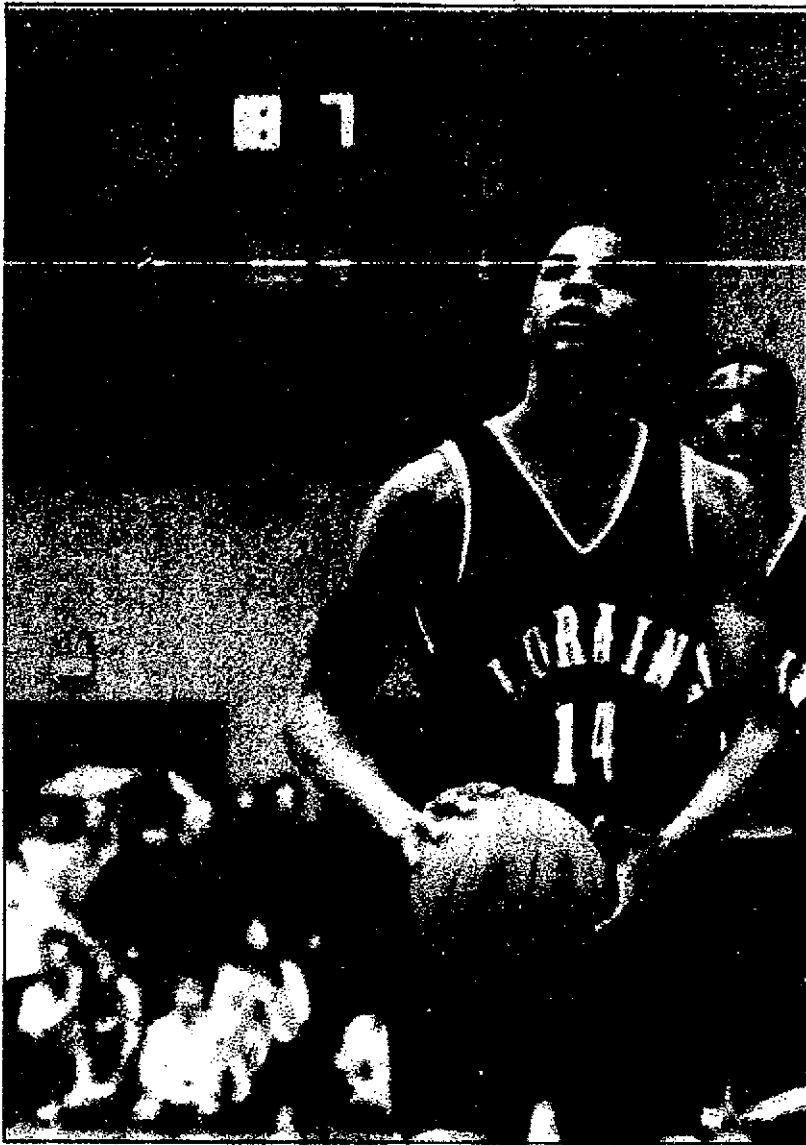
The Bulldogs defeated Bay 79-56 and 61-51 in Southwestern Conference action earlier in the season.

Falls, 17-6, advances to the Toledo regional Tuesday when it meets Clyde, the winner of the Ashland University district, at 8:15. Clyde (19-4) advanced by edging Norwalk 63-61 Saturday.

"That idea about beating a good team three times is overrated," said Falls coach Pat Donahue. "We didn't have to win three times, we only had to beat them once. Tonight was all that mattered.

"The whole team thought we should win if we played the

See FALLS, B3



CHUCK HUMEL / CHRONICLE

UNDER PRESSURE: As the scoreboard in the background shows, Lorain's Carl White was looking at some crucial free throws in Saturday night's Division I district title game. White's free throw with 18 seconds to play put Lorain ahead 41-40 and the Steelmen went on to post a 43-40 win.

District title keeps Lorain's dream alive

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

GRAFTON — It's one for the history books.

Never before has Lorain High won a district basketball championship. Never, that is, until Saturday night.

Lorain, the proud old school a couple of blocks off Broadway may shut its doors as a senior high school this spring, but it won't be able to shut down its memories. The Steelmen gave Lakewood a dose of its own defensive medicine in knocking off the top-seeded Rangers, 43-40, to claim the Division I district title before an overflow crowd at Midview.

Lorain, 17-6, advances to the "Sweet 16" for the first time since 1923 when it won the state title under a different format from today's, when all sixteen teams competed in the state finals. It's a far cry from the team that opened the season with a 15-point loss to Lorain Catholic. With its win over Lakewood, Lorain has now beaten every team on its schedule. It knocked off the top two seeds and the host school at Midview.

Meanwhile, Lakewood, 18-5, is still looking for its first regional bid since 1949. Lorain will open regional play against Euclid Wednesday at Cleveland State.

"They just refuse to lose," said John Rositano, the first year — and unfortunately last — coach of

the Steelmen. "I can see it in their eyes. They refuse to back down. They refuse to quit."

"They (the Steelmen) were on a mission," said Lakewood coach Bob Patton, who saw his team defeat the Steelmen, 52-49, in December. "Their kids played with so much heart and so much desire. It's nice to see that in a basketball team."

The game was a defensive war from start to finish with each successive possession taking on more importance. Lorain led by three, 12-9, in the first period. Lakewood had a five-point lead, 19-14, late in the first half.

Those were the biggest margins either team would enjoy until the start of the final eight minutes when the Steelmen made it known they wanted to break up what could have been an all Lake Erie League field had Mentor and Lakewood joined Cleveland Heights and Valley Forge at CSU. Ironically, Lorain was a member of that league until 1956 when the now defunct Buckeye Conference came into existence.

"All we're trying to do is play defense and give us a chance to win basketball games," said Rositano. "We're not an offensive juggernaut but we play good, sound defense and force the other team to make mistakes."

To start the final period, Joe

See LORAIN, B3

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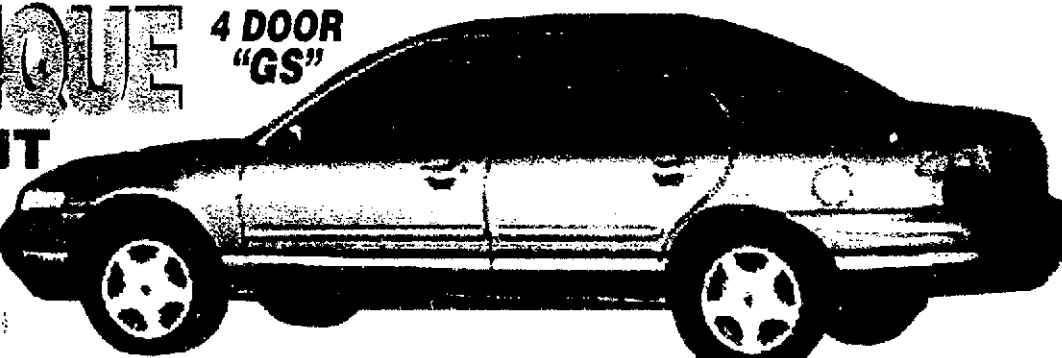
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